

SM Seaside City Cebu

Interactive Sales Deck - Design Rationale

1. Design Rationale

The audience shapes everything. This deck is a pitch tool for a specific person: a leasing manager, a brand sponsorship director, or an events booker. That person is time-poor, visually literate, and evaluating multiple venues at once. Every decision was made with that in mind.

Visual tone: luxury without coldness. SM Seaside City is home to international luxury brands and a landmark 147 m tower. The deck needed to feel premium without feeling corporate. The near-black background, gold accent, and wide negative space signal confidence. Cormorant Garamond was chosen for headlines - a typeface that shares DNA with Hermes and Saint Laurent - paired with Inter for body copy, which stays legible at small sizes and on mobile.

Non-linear navigation. A sticky side-rail nav with scroll-spy lets any prospect jump directly to the section most relevant to their role - a leasing manager goes straight to Leasing, a brand manager jumps to Sponsorship. The scroll progress bar tells them how much content remains. The experience respects the viewer's time rather than forcing a linear slide-by-slide path.

Reduce friction at the point of intent. The floating + widget (bottom-right) is always visible. When a prospect is ready to act - whether on section two or nine - they don't need to scroll to a contact page. It expands into four direct actions: Leasing Inquiry, Sponsorship, Book a Venue, and a direct phone number. The contact modal is triggered from multiple CTAs and always renders the same up-to-date contact card. One source of truth, zero dead ends.

Performance as a design choice. The deck is a single static file - index.html, style.css, main.js - with all images hosted locally. No framework, no CDN dependency. It opens instantly from a USB drive in a client meeting room with no Wi-Fi. The hero slideshow preloads the next image in advance to eliminate blank flashes, and pauses automatically when the tab is hidden.

2. AI Usage

Three AI tools were used across research, planning, and implementation - each for a distinct purpose.

- * **Perplexity AI** - Used for fast fact-checking and research. Verified SM Seaside City statistics (floor area, store count, attraction specs such as ice rink dimensions and cinema seat count) against publicly available sources before committing any numbers to the deck.

- * **ChatGPT (OpenAI)** - Used during early planning and content phases. Brainstormed the deck's narrative structure, drafted initial section copy, and generated alternative headline and CTA options to compare against.

- * **Claude (Anthropic)** - Primary development assistant for the full build. Authored the HTML structure, semantic sections, and ARIA patterns. Wrote the entire CSS design system - dark/gold palette, custom properties, responsive breakpoints, hero transitions, and IntersectionObserver reveal animations.

Implemented all JavaScript: scroll progress bar, hero slideshow with visibility-pause and preload, scroll-spy

nav, smooth scroll, mobile hamburger, float widget, contact modal, and animated stat counters. Also assisted with copywriting, CTA text, and attraction detail copy.

- * **Claude Code (CLI)** - Used in the terminal across sessions to apply targeted multi-file edits, run a dead-CSS removal pass, manage git commits, consolidate all assets into a single directory, and redesign the contact popup into a structured card layout.

Key distinction: Perplexity for facts, ChatGPT for early narrative, Claude + Claude Code for all design and implementation. All photography is verified factual imagery of SM Seaside City Cebu - no AI-generated images were used.

3. What I Would Improve With More Time

- * **Leasing path module** - The current Leasing section is a single CTA. A category-selector (retail, F&B, services, luxury) surfacing relevant floor options and a pre-filled inquiry form per category would let prospects self-qualify rather than calling cold.

- * **Sponsorship tier cards** - Replace prose with a structured Bronze / Silver / Gold / Title tier table, with audience reach numbers visualised as simple inline SVG bar charts. Far more persuasive to a brand manager than paragraphs.

- * **Offline-safe fonts** - The deck currently loads fonts from Google Fonts. In a meeting room with no internet the browser falls back to system fonts and breaks the visual hierarchy. Self-hosting via @font-face would fix this.

- * **Scroll-triggered counters** - Headline stats (470,486 m2, 700+ stores) currently animate on page load. Triggering them on IntersectionObserver - counting up the moment the viewer scrolls to them - would make them land with more impact.

- * **Print / PDF export mode** - A @media print stylesheet that expands all sections and strips animations would let the deck double as a clean A4 leave-behind PDF - useful for post-meeting follow-ups with no extra tooling.

- * **Analytics** - A lightweight tracker on section entry and CTA clicks would tell the sales team which sections hold attention and which CTAs convert - closing the feedback loop between the deck and the actual sales process.

Three sessions. Zero framework dependencies. One file to open.